

Know Your Consumer Rights

Being treated unfairly by a company, debt collector, or scammer? You have powerful federal rights — and free ways to fight back. Below are the official resources. Tick the box once you’ve checked each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Federal agencies exist to protect you, and complaining to them is free and often effective. Companies frequently fix problems fast once a regulator is involved. Never pay anyone who promises to “recover” scam money for a fee.

1 Money & Debt Protections

Your rights with banks, lenders, and debt collectors.

☐ CFPB — File a Complaint

The Consumer Financial Protection Bureau helps with banks, loans, credit, and debt collectors. Companies usually must respond.

→ www.consumerfinance.gov/complaint

☐ Debt Collector Rules (FDCPA)

Collectors can’t harass you, call at all hours, or lie. Know your rights and report violations.

→ www.consumerfinance.gov/consumer-tools/debt-collection

2 Scams & Unfair Business

Report fraud and unfair practices to the nation’s consumer watchdog.

☐ FTC — Report Fraud

Report scams, identity theft, and unfair business practices, and get a recovery plan.

→ reportfraud.ftc.gov

☐ IdentityTheft.gov

If your identity was stolen, get a free step-by-step recovery plan.

→ www.identitytheft.gov

3 Your Credit Rights

Check and fix your credit for free.

☐ Free Credit Reports

Get your credit reports free every week from all three bureaus.

→ www.annualcreditreport.com

☐ Dispute Credit Errors

You have the right to dispute and fix errors on your credit report for free.

→ www.consumerfinance.gov/ask-cfpb/how-do-i-dispute-an-error-on-my-credit-report-en-314

4 More Help

Other trusted places to resolve consumer problems.

☐ State Attorney General & Consumer Protection

Your state AG handles many consumer complaints. Search your state + "attorney general consumer complaint."

→ Search your state + 'attorney general consumer protection'

☐ USA.gov — Consumer Help

The government's hub for consumer complaints and your rights.

→ www.usa.gov/consumer-complaints

⚠ WATCH OUT FOR

If someone contacts you promising to recover money you lost to a scam — for a fee — that's a second scam. Real government help (FTC, CFPB) is always free. Never pay to file a complaint.

★ A TIP THAT HELPS

Put complaints in writing and keep records of every call and letter. A complaint to the CFPB or FTC creates a paper trail that often gets results when calling the company didn't.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers federal protections. For your state's consumer agencies and local help, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
